

PMBOK / PMI | PMB-07

Scope Management Plan

How scope will be defined, validated and controlled

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Scope Management Plan
Document reference	PMB-07-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
PMB-09	Project Scope Statement	Produced under this plan
PMB-10	Work Breakdown Structure and Dictionary	Produced under this plan
PMB-26	Change Request Form and Change Log	Controls scope change

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Establishes how the project and product scope will be defined, developed, monitored, controlled and validated, including how the WBS is created and maintained and how deliverables are formally accepted.
Framework	PMBOK / PMI — Scope Management — Plan Scope Management
Created when	During planning
Reviewed / updated	Through change control only, once baselined
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	On smaller projects combine this with the requirements management plan. Keep the acceptance process explicit whatever you combine.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- The acceptance process names who accepts each type of deliverable
- Scope change control is distinguished from progressive elaboration
- The WBS creation approach and decomposition rules are stated
- Scope validation is separated from quality control
- Gold plating is explicitly addressed as unacceptable

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1. Scope definition process

How requirements become a scope statement, and who is involved at each step.

In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. *Out of scope:* the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.

2. WBS creation approach

Field	Detail
Decomposition approach	<i>e.g. By deliverable</i>
Lowest level (work package) definition	<i>e.g. 40–80 hours of effort</i>
Coding structure	<i>Applies across DXB-1 halls A and B for the Tranche 2 scale build</i>
WBS dictionary detail level	<i>Any deviation requires a recorded waiver accepted by the CISO with a stated expiry</i>
Maintenance responsibility	<i>Constrained by the 6.2 MVA site limit at DXB-1 until 2028</i>

3. Scope baseline maintenance

What constitutes the baseline and how it is changed.

In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. *Out of scope:* the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.

4. Deliverable acceptance process

Deliverable type	Acceptance criteria source	Reviewer	Accepter	Evidence retained
<i>Independent security assurance report with findings closed</i>	<i>Configuration management database</i>	<i>18 Sep 2026</i>	<i>P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead</i>	<i>ALM tool — Helios ART board</i>
<i>Operations runbook set with two completed live drills</i>	<i>Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance</i>	<i>15 Oct 2026</i>	<i>G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead</i>	<i>Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate</i>
<i>Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained</i>	<i>Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space</i>	<i>30 Nov 2026</i>	<i>M. Verity, Head of P3O</i>	<i>Configuration management database</i>
<i>Hall A accepted at</i>	<i>ALM tool — Helios ART</i>	<i>15 Dec 2026</i>	<i>I. Petrova, Data</i>	<i>Programme</i>

Deliverable type	Acceptance criteria source	Reviewer	Accepter	Evidence retained
1,024 GPUs with acceptance certificate	board		Platform Lead	SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance
Platform v1.0 — scheduling, quota, observability and image supply chain	Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate	31 Jan 2027	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space
400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated	Configuration management database	26 Feb 2027	G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead	ALM tool — Helios ART board

5. Scope change control

Change type	Assessment required	Authority	Turnaround
Clarification within baseline	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate on 18 Sep 2026, v1.0	Project manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate on 18 Sep 2026, v1.0
Change within tolerance	Level 2 — repeatable	Programme Board	10 working days
Change exceeding tolerance	Level 2 — repeatable	Sponsor / board	10 working days
Emergency change	Required to prevent service loss or harm — Programme Manager acts and seeks retrospective approval within 48 hours	Programme Board	Required to prevent service loss or harm — Programme Manager acts and seeks retrospective approval within 48 hours

6. Preventing scope creep

Practical controls, not statements of intent.

- All scope additions enter through the change request process without exception
- Requirements are traced to the scope baseline; untraced work is challenged
- Gold plating is not permitted — additional functionality is a change, not a gift
- Verbal agreements do not change scope

7. Roles and responsibilities

Activity	Responsible	Accountable	Consulted	Informed
Tune congestion control and benchmark NCCL	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	N. Ozturk, ML Platform Lead	Service Operations and FM provider	Agile Release Train — all teams

Activity	Responsible	Accountable	Consulted	Informed
<i>Build leaf-spine fabric in hall A</i>	<i>V. Chandra, Product Management</i>	<i>B. Oyelaran, Quality and Assurance Lead</i>	<i>Agile Release Train — all teams</i>	<i>Programme Board</i>
<i>Install CDUs and secondary cooling loop</i>	<i>M. Verity, Head of P3O</i>	<i>T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect</i>	<i>Programme Board</i>	<i>Programme Manager and workstream leads</i>
<i>Install switchgear and energise 6 MVA supply</i>	<i>G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead</i>	<i>F. Mansour, Business Change Lead</i>	<i>Programme Manager and workstream leads</i>	<i>CISO and Security Architect</i>